

Ivan Yuri “Lion” P. De Leon

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EDUCATION

Ateneo de Manila University

Master in Data Science

Quezon City, Philippines

May 2026

- Graduate Assistant – Mathematics Department & Environmental Science Department
- *Coursework:* Deep Learning, Computer Vision, Bayesian Techniques, Time Series Forecasting, Big Data, Data Visualization

Ateneo de Manila University

BS in Applied Mathematics (Data Science), Minor in Economics

Quezon City, Philippines

May 2025

- Summa Cum Laude and University Academic Scholar
- Mulry Award for Literary Excellence: highest distinction in literary writing given to honor students
- Managing Editor & Finance Officer, HEIGHTS Ateneo (official literary & artistic publication)
- *Coursework:* Machine Learning, Linear Algebra & Statistics, Natural Language Processing, Graph Theory, Operations Research, Business Intelligence, Microeconomics & Macroeconomics, Financial Economics, Seminar on Finance, Linguistics

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Ateneo de Manila University

Graduate Assistant

Quezon City, Philippines

Jan 2026 - May 2026

- Taught review sessions on differential and integral calculus, and proctored exams for the Mathematics Department.
- Supported program operations (creative assets, communication, event logistics, documentation) and assisted in building a library cataloging system for the Environmental Science Department.

Ayala Corporation

Data Analytics and AI Intern

Makati, Philippines

Apr 2025 - Sept 2025

- Led the collaborative effort between Ayala Corp and AC Mobility data scientists, analyzing 6 years of dealership data to identify key features driving car sales; AC Mobility incorporated these features into their forecasting model, lowering prediction error.
- Automated workforce analytics by building a real-time HR dashboard for 200+ employees' attrition and leave data, cutting report generation time from monthly to instant by replacing manual compilation with self-updating flexible queries.
- Queried, preprocessed, and quality-checked nationwide EV charging station data to surface usage and demand patterns, generating insights that informed multiple business decisions across the organization.
- Modeled the app behavior of 5,000+ early adopters in a mobility app using Markov chains, shaping the team's feature prioritization roadmap.

Bank of the Philippine Islands

Data Science Intern

Makati, Philippines

Jun 2024 - Aug 2024

- Delivered 4 finance-focused data science projects in 2 months: car loan data scraping, a financial product recommendation system, customer segmentation for tailored service delivery, and explainable AI for credit risk modeling.
- Conceived and designed a pilot coworking space initiative for Ayala Group companies, validated through consultation with five senior leaders; finalist (3/20 teams) in a conglomerate-wide case competition, with potential impact for 10,000+ employees.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Gigascale Laboratories

Visiting Researcher

Sydney, Australia

Jun 2026 - Present

- Developing a sandbox platform to study single-agent alignment drift within multi-agent social media ecosystems, investigating how agents degrade under exposure to adversarial or roleplaying peer agents.

Technical Alignment Research Accelerator

AI Alignment Fellow

Quezon City, Philippines

Mar 2026 - Jun 2026

- Admitted to a competitive APAC-wide alignment training program, covering transformers, mechanistic interpretability, reinforcement learning, LLM evaluation, and AI agents.
- Built two research capstones in two weeks: (1) a [mechanistic interpretability](#) study on alignment drift in multi-agent systems with Sydney-based collaborators, recognized among the cohort's top projects; (2) a [jailbreaking study](#) introducing a Filipino persuasive prompt generation method achieving up to 62% jailbreak success, outperforming English across most risk categories.

AI Safety Diliman - AI Governance Accelerator

AI Governance Fellow

Quezon City, Philippines

Feb 2026 - May 2026

- Completed a 10-week AI governance and policy program, with a [final project](#) developing an evaluation framework, in partnership with Sigla Research Center, assessing AI models on Philippine current affairs for accuracy, overconfidence, and political bias.

Nara Institute of Science and Technology

Human-AI Interaction Lab Intern

Nara, Japan

Jan 2026

- Curated an [image dataset](#) and developed a 4,000-question benchmark evaluating vision-language models' recognition and knowledge of Philippine cultural heritage, building an evaluation pipeline using UK AISI's Inspect framework.

LEADERSHIP & VOLUNTEERING

Safe AI Philippines (formerly AI Safety Diliman)

Core Volunteer

Philippines

Jul 2026 - Present

- Part of the core team relaunching AI Safety Diliman as Safe AI Philippines, collating past AI governance projects and shaping the

organization's new direction and content strategy.

- Contributed policy analysis on a pending Philippine AI regulatory bill, the country's first comprehensive AI governance framework, to support the organization's participation in the House of Representatives' Technical Working Group.

HEIGHTS Ateneo (*official literary and artistic publication*)

Quezon City, Philippines

Various Roles

Jun 2021 - May 2025

- Managing Editor for Finance: served in a dual role as Finance Officer and Executive Editor, managing financial transactions, printing operations, and supplier coordination, while advising the editorial board on promoting art and literature on campus.
- Filipino Staff Editor: supervised and trained a team of 12 staffers in editorial work, championing Filipino literature on a primarily English-speaking campus; spearheaded Bantay Sining at Panitikan, a quick-response team addressing political and literary events.
- Deliberating Staffer: read and critiqued Filipino literary submissions for publication consideration.

Pasig City Youth Parliament

Pasig City, Philippines

Youth Parliamentarian

Aug 2025

- Authored a policy proposing a city volunteer corps and a resolution designing a civic hackathon, as a delegate under the Committee on Global Mobility and Active Citizenship.

SELECT PROJECTS

[\[Portfolio Website\]](#)

Graph-Based Analysis of Customer-Merchant Payment Networks

Master's Capstone

- Independently designed a customer-merchant affinity metric in collaboration with BPI, applying community detection and graph neural networks across 4.4M transactions to surface the behavioral pattern of the bank's wealthiest customer segment.
- Identified 18 hidden customers that belong to BPI's high-value segment with high confidence and 20 merchants strongly associated with that segment's preferences—insights ready for the bank to verify and act on.

BEA: Blue Eagle Assistant (AI Chatbot)

[\[Repo\]](#) [\[Slides\]](#) [\[Video\]](#)

- Independently built a multi-agent university chatbot using LangGraph and Streamlit, so students can instantly get answers on handbook policies, offices, contacts, and class schedules through a RAG-powered pipeline.

Volatility Modeling on the USD-PHP Exchange Rate using ARMA-GARCH Models

[\[Repo\]](#) [\[Paper\]](#)

- Modeled daily USD-PHP exchange rates (Jul 2024–Jul 2025) with a team using a joint ARIMA(1,2,2)-GARCH(1,1) approach, capturing mean dynamics and time-varying volatility; forecasts revealed a mild depreciation trend and widening volatility bands signaling rising short-term currency risk.

We Are Convinced That Persuasion is Linear and Bilingual in LLMs

[\[Repo\]](#) [\[Paper\]](#)

- Identified that five persuasion techniques in LLMs converge on a shared internal direction; amplifying it made AI responses measurably more persuasive in both English and Tagalog.
- Found this persuasion direction transfers strongly across languages, suggesting AI models represent persuasion independent of language, though results may be partly influenced by response structure; placed in the top half of the APART Hackathon.

PUBLICATIONS

PACUTE: Phonology-, Affix-, and Character-level Understanding of Tokens for Filipino

[\[Preprint\]](#)

- Developed a diagnostic benchmark of 4,600 tasks for morphological understanding in Filipino, covering infixation, reduplication, and diacritic-driven distinctions that standard tokenizers fail to capture. Submitted to EMNLP 2026.

Tanawpamana: Benchmarking Vision-Language Models on Philippine Cultural Heritage Sites

- Curated a 500-image dataset and developed a 4,000-question benchmark evaluating vision-language models' recognition and knowledge of Philippine cultural heritage sites. Submitted to O-COCOSDA 2026.

OTHER DETAILS

- **Tools:** Python (Scikit-learn, PyTorch), R, SQL, Power BI, Apache Spark, Google Cloud Platform, Java, Git, Django, Streamlit
- **Data Skills:** NLP, Machine Learning, Deep Learning, Network Analysis, Time Series, Big Data Processing, Web Scraping
- **Advocacy:** AI Safety (independent research on technical alignment and AI evaluation; trained through TARA Program, BlueDot Impact, and Safe AI Philippines); Filipino Intellectualization (active use and study of the Filipino language in academic research)
- **Literary Arts:** Recipient of the National Youth Achievement in Literary Arts (Philippine National Committee on Literary Arts, 2025); published in TLDTD Journal, HEIGHTS Ateneo Folio, and Bente-Bente Zine